

amicable solution to the nuclear deal issue. Given the rigid stand adopted by both parties, it seems the talks will go on indefinitely without coming to any sort of settlement.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

UP = Upturned Police

Uttar Pradesh has an ugly political structure which has so far been hanging between Mayawati and Mulayam Singh Yadav ("Off With Their Khakis", September 24). The sacking of over 6,500 policemen is yet another case in point.

SUBHASH C. AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

Why did the previous state government appoint such people without verifying their credentials? The Allahabad High Court is right in observing that corrupt bureaucrats are responsible for flooding the courts with cases.

ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

Dwarfed Giant

The magazine has produced a very perceptive article on Ram Gopal Varma ("The Unmaking of an Icon", September 24). Even wannabe voyeurs would gag where his gang of girls is concerned. They have crossed the line between sexy and sleazy a number of times. One wonders where will Varma go from here?

SHEILA KUMAR, *on e-mail*

Love in the Times of Stress

Today physical gratification takes precedence over emotional intimacy (Hors D'Oeuvres: Emotional Infidelity, September 17). In fact, even male bonding and those heart-to-heart sessions between women

are equable to emotional infidelity since one is doing everything that is done with a partner except sleeping.

POONAM NARANG, *Ambala*

Neighbouring Woes

For long, we have been a victim of terror perpetrated by our neighbour ("The Dhaka Dilemma", September 17). And now, Bangladesh is emerging as another threat. Our politicians need to get their act together and

come down hard on such forces of terror.

SAMARTH GARG, *Delhi*

Defend Yourself

It is surprising that a country as technically developed as India should depend on others for its defence needs ("The Mother of All Deals", September 17). We must not underestimate ourselves and push for self-reliance in such crucial sectors.

JORDAN C. FAN, *on e-mail*

NEARING THE END



Democracy has failed in Pakistan ("No Entry", September 24). Military rulers have seized control of the country time and again and things have now turned so bad that one of them has not allowed a democratically elected prime minister to enter the country. Hopefully, Pakistan will not go further downhill.

S.P. SHARMA, *Mumbai*

A government cannot stop anyone from entering their own country, though it has every right to restrain someone from leaving and General Musharraf has committed political harakiri by preventing former prime minister Nawaz Sharif from entering Pakistan.

K. PRADEEP, *Chennai*

Those who live by the sword, die in a similar fashion. Musharraf is sure to prove this correct.

SARANG SHAMSHERI, *on e-mail*

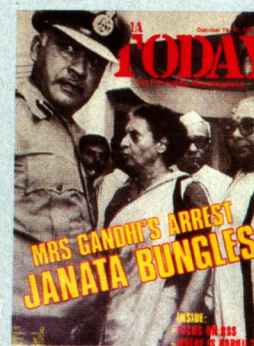
Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

e-mail your letters to: letters.editor@intoday.com
or fax them to: 011-23316180

30

Years Ago in India Today

OCTOBER 16-31, 1977



Arty-Craft Symbols

There is nothing saintly in Satish Gujral except in the momentary martyrdom he assumes when talking of sins. Sinning has brought him success; success has elevated his price; and at his kind of prices, he's selling swiftly. But he doesn't like the sound of the word bestseller. And passion perhaps is the key to Gujral.

Changing passions, passions of Satish Gujral change: the view of the artist assumes a new coherence. So does his work. His latest exhibition of about 15 canvases opens at the Dhoomimal Art Gallery on October 21. It might be fashionable to talk of Gujral's new artistic phase, his change of medium, but the artist has returned to his roots: oil on textured canvas, on which in the fifties, he emblazoned the holocaust of the Indian Partition. Between the holocaust of 1947 and the holocaust of recent memory, his art might have been altered beyond recognition.

—Aman Nath, *Mandira Purie*

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE CALL: (95120) 2479900 from DELHI and FARIDABAD; (0120) 2479900 from REST OF INDIA; Fax (0120) 4078080 KOLKATA: Tel 22821922, 22827726, 22825398 Fax 22825398, 22827254 BANGALORE: Tel 2212448, 2290562, 2218343 Fax 2218335 MUMBAI: Tel 24444423/4/5/6 Fax 24444358 CHENNAI: Tel 28478525-44 Fax 28472178. FOR CUSTOMER CARE CALL: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines) 120 2479900 (Monday–Friday; 10am–6 pm); WRITE IN: WE CARE, The India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (U.P.)-201301. e-mail: wecare@intoday.com